GRE Weekly Study Calendar

Daily Micro-Study Blocks, Weekend Deep Work Sessions, Vocabulary Cadence & Milestone Testing

1. The Working Professional vs Full-Time Student Schedule Matrix

Compare realistic study architectures designed to maximize retention while managing demanding work or college commitments.

Dimension	Working Professional Schedule	Full-Time Student / Dedicated Prep Schedule
Weekly Hour Capacity	12 to 15 Hours / Week	20 to 28 Hours / Week
Recommended Calendar Duration	8 to 10 Weeks (Roughly 60 to 75 Days)	4 to 6 Weeks (Roughly 30 to 45 Days)
Weekday Study Structure	60 to 75 Mins: 45 min morning drill (6:30 AM) + 20 min evening vocab review	2 to 3 Hours: 90 min morning Quant + 60 min afternoon Verbal + 30 min vocab
Weekend Study Structure	3.5 Hours Saturday (Mock / Timed Set) + 3.5 Hours Sunday (Forensic Review)	4 Hours Saturday (Full Test Simulation) + 4 Hours Sunday (Deep Error Log Analysis)
Vocabulary Cadence	15 new words/day using spaced-repetition mobile apps during commutes	25 to 30 new words/day + etymology root analysis and practice sets
Full-Length Mock Cadence	1 mock every 10 to 14 days (Total 4 to 5 full practice tests)	1 mock every 6 to 7 days (Total 5 to 6 full practice tests)

Principle: Consistency beats cramming. Studying 1.5 hours daily for 60 days produces far higher retention than studying 10 hours on Sundays.

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2. The 7-Day Weekly Study Template

A balanced weekly timetable alternating between Quantitative Reasoning, Verbal Logic, and Vocabulary.

Day of the Week	Morning Focus (45 Mins)	Evening Focus (20 Mins)	Weekly Milestone Target
Monday	Quant Arithmetic & Number Properties (15 questions)	Vocabulary Review (Words 1–60)	Zero exponent and divisibility errors
Tuesday	Verbal Text Completion 1-Blank & 2-Blank sets (12 questions)	Flashcard Active Recall Drill	Master contrast and support roadmaps
Wednesday	Quant Algebra & Quantitative Comparison drills (15 questions)	Review previous week error log	Enforce the ZONEF number testing protocol
Thursday	Verbal Sentence Equivalence & Synonym Pairing (15 questions)	Vocabulary Review (Words 61–120)	Pair identification under 45 seconds/Q
Friday	Quant Geometry & Data Interpretation sets (12 questions)	Light flashcard refresh before rest	Axis reading and unit verification
Saturday	Full-Length Official Practice Test (Timed, no pauses)	Rest of day off to recharge	Build test stamina and section adaptation
Sunday	Untimed Blind Re-solve of all mock errors + Error Logging	Weekly planning for next sprint	Update 4-bucket error taxonomy

Burnout Rule: Designate one evening (e.g. Friday night) as completely study-free to keep your brain sharp.

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3. Vocabulary Retention Protocol: The 1-3-7 Spaced Repetition Rule

How to memorize 800+ high-frequency GRE words so they stick permanently until test day.

- Day 1 (Introduction): Learn 15 new words with primary definitions, secondary meanings, and sample sentences.
- Day 3 (First Review): Test yourself on Day 1 words without looking at definitions; mark words that faltered.
- Day 7 (Second Review): Re-test Day 1 words along with Day 3 words; move mastered words to the passive queue.
- Day 21 (Monthly Check): Run a rapid-fire quiz on all words learned that month to guarantee long-term neural encoding.